

Djokovic Loses to Hurkacz in Shanghai Days After Winning in Beijing

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Tennis star Novak Djokovic had a big surprise at the Shanghai Masters in China. Just three days after winning the China Open in Beijing, he lost his second-round match to Hubert Hurkacz of Poland.

Hurkacz, who won the Shanghai **tournament** in 2023 and is ranked 34th in the world, won 6-4, 6-3 in 87 minutes. It was the first time he had ever beaten Djokovic. The two had played eight times before, and Djokovic had won every match.

Hurkacz is known for his powerful **serve**. Djokovic lost his **serve** just once in each set, and that was enough to decide the match.

"It's a special night," Hurkacz said. "I've been playing Novak for like seven years." He called Djokovic a **legend** and said it was a pleasure to share a court with him.

The loss came at the end of a busy **stretch**. It was Djokovic's sixth match in 10 days. In Beijing, the 39-year-old won the 102nd title of his career after his opponent in the final, Alex de Minaur, had to stop because of an injury. That title ended an 11-month wait for a trophy. It also meant Djokovic, who holds the men's record of 24 **Grand Slam** titles, has won at least one tour title for 21 years in a row.

Djokovic is trying to **qualify** for the ATP Finals, a special end-of-season event for the top eight players. He is currently ninth in the race, so he will need a strong result at the Paris Masters in November.

Also in Shanghai, Britain's Arthur Fery lost a long three-set match to Karen Khachanov that lasted about three and a half hours.

Word Treasure

Grand Slam -- One of tennis's four biggest tournaments: the Australian Open, French Open, Wimbledon and US Open.

serve -- The shot that starts each point in tennis.

legend -- A person who is famous and admired for great achievements over a long time.

qualify -- To earn a place in a competition by meeting its requirements.

tournament -- A competition made up of a series of matches.

stretch -- A continuous period of time.

Background you need

Professional tennis players travel to tournaments around the world, earning points and titles across a long season.

The Masters events are some of the biggest tournaments outside the four Grand Slams.

The ATP Finals is held at the end of the season, and only the eight men with the best results that year earn a place.

Novak Djokovic is one of the most successful players in tennis history and has played at the top level for many years.

Break it down

LEAD: Djokovic loses in Shanghai three days after winning in Beijing

KEY EVENT: Hurkacz wins 6-4, 6-3 in 87 minutes

+ - WHO: Novak Djokovic and Hubert Hurkacz

+ - WHERE: Shanghai Masters, China

+ - FIRST: Hurkacz's first win in nine meetings

CONTEXT: Sixth match in 10 days; 102nd career title in Beijing

QUOTE: Hurkacz calls Djokovic a legend

WHAT NEXT: Djokovic, ninth in the race, needs a strong Paris Masters to reach the ATP Finals

Why it matters

Even the greatest champions can be beaten, and this loss makes Djokovic's push to reach the season-ending ATP Finals harder.

Test what you remember

1. Who beat Novak Djokovic in Shanghai?
 - ☐ (A) Alex de Minaur
 - ☐ (B) Karen Khachanov
 - ☐ (C) Hubert Hurkacz
 - ☐ (D) Arthur Fery
2. What was the score of the match?
 - ☐ (A) 6-2, 6-1
 - ☐ (B) 6-3, 6-4
 - ☐ (C) 6-4, 6-3
 - ☐ (D) 7-6, 6-7, 7-6
3. How many times had Djokovic beaten Hurkacz before this match?
 - ☐ (A) Eight
 - ☐ (B) Two
 - ☐ (C) Five
 - ☐ (D) Twelve
4. Which tournament did Djokovic win three days earlier?
 - ☐ (A) Wimbledon
 - ☐ (B) The Australian Open
 - ☐ (C) The Paris Masters
 - ☐ (D) The China Open in Beijing
5. How many matches had Djokovic played in 10 days?
 - ☐ (A) Three
 - ☐ (B) Four
 - ☐ (C) Six
 - ☐ (D) Ten
6. Where does Djokovic need a strong result to reach the ATP Finals?
 - ☐ (A) The China Open
 - ☐ (B) The US Open
 - ☐ (C) The Shanghai Masters
 - ☐ (D) The Paris Masters

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: C 3: A 4: D 5: C 6: D

Questions to think about

1. Hubert Hurkacz: Calls it a special night and says it was a pleasure to share a court with a legend like Djokovic.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):